

How to Select the Right Tablet



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Tablets are slowly becoming popular, as these have a lot more to offer in terms of style and substance. Tablets represent the biggest shift in the computing industry. These are regarded as a replacement to the traditional personal computers (PCs) and laptops. Desktops have not disappeared but have been replaced in popularity by laptops, which, in turn, are now threatened by tablets.

Tablets are typically more powerful than smartphones. Unlike desktops and many laptops, tablets are fast to start up and you can be off and running in no time, wherever you are. These exhibit a strong battery life, which makes these ideal for work while on the move. Unlike computers and laptops, tablets are more intuitive and easy to use.

A tablet selection is often influenced as per the intent of use. Listed here are some of the key features and their benefits identified that will enable you to select the right tablet according to your requirement.

Key features

Operating system. Broadly, the operating systems (OS) that run a tablet can be classified into Android, iOS and Windows. Android and iOS (iPads) have dominated the tablet scene in recent years, but Windows tablet category is also showing growth.

Android OS developed by Google is found on many tablets and mobile phones. Different versions are available and all have a version number and a dessert-themed name, for example, Android 3.0 Honeycomb, Android 4.3 Jelly Bean, Android 4.4 KitKat and the like. Bigger numbers indicate the latest version with more features than the previous one. Android has a robust apps-and-content marketplace called Google Play, which comes with a huge suite of services from Google including Google Now, Hangouts, Gmail, Google Calendar, Google Maps and a lot more.

iOS is the OS for Apple tablets, namely, iPads. It is extremely easy and intuitive to use and gives you access to Apple's App Store. If you own other Apple devices or enjoy services like iTunes, the iPad

may be the ideal solution for you. The user interface is accessible and very slick but it does not allow for much in the way of customisation.

Windows based tablets come closest to offering a traditional computing experience, like what you might find on a PC or laptop. Since Windows based tablets offer the use of full versions of software like Microsoft Office, it may be an ideal choice for official work. Further, there are more than 200,000 apps in Windows Store, designed to be touch-friendly. Windows offers support for multiple user accounts and boasts a robust set of parental controls.

Storage. Tablets come with a wide range of storage from as little as 4GB up to 64GB. Many of the top-brand tablets come with a flash memory of 8GB, 16GB, 32GB or 64GB. Ideally, a tablet with 16GB of internal (flash) memory is suitable where users need to surf only. However, if downloading, storing data and more is required, it is always recommended to opt for the largest memory-size tablet.

Wi-Fi or 3G. If you intend to mainly use your tablet at home and you already have broadband and a wireless router then Wi-Fi might be all you need. Nowadays, public places such as cafes, pubs, hotels and airports provide free or paid Wi-Fi.

Some tablets can also connect to the 3G mobile network, allowing you to get online pretty much anywhere, as you do with your mobile phone. Therefore opt for a Wi-Fi or 3G based tablet, depending on where you want to use it.

Screens. Another important factor while buying a tablet is its screen size. Tablet screens vary in size with the majority starting from 17.8cm (7-inch) and going up to 35.6cm (14-inch).

Along with screen size, the resolution is another feature that is determined by the number of pixels that make up a screen. Higher the number of pixels, the more finer details can be displayed and the sharper the text appears. A resolution of 1280 × 720 and above makes the text and images ap-

A tablet computer, or a tablet, is a mobile computer with a touchscreen display, circuitry and battery in a single device

